
LESSONS IN LIKUTAY TORAH

PRECIOUS TEACHINGS THAT AWAKEN THE HEART
TO DIVINE SERVICE FROM THE HOLY MASTER
❧ **RABBI SHNEUR ZALMAN OF LIADI** ❧
TRANSLATED AND EXPLAINED

לְקוּטֵי תוֹרָה

פְּרֶשֶׁת רְאָה - אֶלוּל

דְּבוּר הַמִּתְחִיל

"אֲנִי לְדוּדֵי [ב]"

“Elul- the power for Teshuva”

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ב"ה

Likutay Torah English translation project:

With Hashem's help we would like to present this installment of **Lessons in Likutay Torah.**

The original text of the maamarim with נקודות and punctuation is presented side by side with a phrase by phrase translation and explanation. The translation of the text is in **bold** whereas the commentary is in regular font. The explanations of general concepts that are not directly relevant to understanding the flow of the maamar are in footnotes.

All of the commentary of the Tzemach Tzedek printed with brackets in the original Likutay Torah have been moved to the Hebrew footnotes and left untranslated.

The Goal

The main purpose of this project is to enable the reader to learn the Likutay Torah in the original. By learning the words, structure, and concepts of the maamarim, eventually they should be able to learn it by themselves in the original.

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and to R' Baruch Katz for creating the website and the editing.

Please Donate to Keep this Project Going

Translating these maamarim takes many hours of work per week, and funding is needed to cover the expenses to make this possible. Please donate at our website www.learnchassidus.com

You can also access there all previous maamarim translations.

For comments and questions please email me at avraham.t.katz@gmail.com

לְקוּטֵי תוֹרָה

דְּבוּר הַמִּתְחִיל

"אֲנִי לְדוּדִי [ב]"

¹ פְּרִשְׁת רֵאָה - אֶלּוּל, דָּף ל"ג, א - ל"ג, ד

“Elul- the power for Teshuva”

Part 1

In the previous maamar in Likutay Torah, entitled **אני לדודי ודודי לי** the Alter Rebbe explained that the words of this verse in Shir HaShirim (which mean “I am connected to the One that I love (meaning to Hashem) and the One who loves me is connected to me”) are specifically connected to the month of Elul, which is why the first letters of those four words spell out the word **אלול**.

He explained that in the month of Elul, Hashem comes out to every Jew and shows them that He cares about them and loves them for who they are, even in their mundane life. This is like a king who goes out to the field to greet the people in their everyday life so they know that he really cares about them, and he shows them a smile and listens to their requests. Once they realize how much the king loves them and how deeply they are really connected to him, the people want to follow the king into his palace and connect to him in all his majesty.

So too in the month of Elul, Hashem shows every Jew that He is very strongly connected to us for who we really are and truly cares about us, even in our mundane physical life, since our neshama is always connected to Hashem no matter what is going on in our lives. Once we remember how strongly we are really connected to Hashem and how much we care about Hashem deep down, we want to push ourselves out of the spiritual limitations of our worldliness and physical desires, and pick ourselves up to truly connect to Hashem in His majesty.

¹ (נֶאֱמַר בְּרִבִּים בְּשֶׁבֶת פְּרִשְׁת תֵּצֵא, ט' אֶלּוּל תִּקְס"ז).

In this maamar the Alter Rebbe continues that theme by explaining the idea of teshuva in general, and particularly how the month of Elul is a time when Hashem reveals His compassion for our neshama by giving it the power to escape all the limitations of the animal soul and truly reconnect to Hashem on the highest level.

We start off by quoting the verse from Shir HaShirim relating to Elul, and we show how it expresses the idea of Hashem's compassion on our Divine soul:

א: Chapter 1:

“אֲנִי לְדוּדִי וְדוּדִי לִי הָרוּעָה
בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים” (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ו, ג):

“I am connected to the One that I love (meaning to Hashem) and the One who loves me is connected to me, He nourishes me with roses.”
(Shir HaShirim 6:3)

הִנֵּה שׁוֹשְׁנָה יֵשׁ בָּהּ תְּלִיסַר עָלֶיךָ,

One of the explanations that Hashem nourishes me by feeding me roses, is that “roses” here is a reference to a certain type of **rose** that **has thirteen petals**,

כְּנֶגֶד "י"ג מְכִילִין דְּרַחֲמֵי"²

which corresponds to the “thirteen attributes of (Hashem's) mercy”,

שְׁבַפְּסוּק (מִיכָה ז, יח-כ) "א- מִי אֵל
כְּמוֹךָ ב- נָשָׂא עוֹן ג- וְעִבֵּר עַל-פְּשָׁע ד-
לְשֹׂאֲרֵית נִחְלָתוֹ ה- לֹא-הִחָזִיק לְעַד אָפוּ ו- כִּי-
חָפֵץ חֶסֶד הוּא: ז- יָשׁוּב יִרְחַמֵּנוּ ח- יִכַּבֵּשׁ
עוֹנֵתֵינוּ ט- וְתִשְׁלֹךְ בְּמַצְלוֹת יָם כָּל-
חַטָּאוֹתֵינוּ: י- תִּתֵּן אֶמֶת לְעֵקֶב יא- חֶסֶד
לְאַבְרָהָם יב- אֲשֶׁר-נִשְׁבַּעְתָּ לְאַבְרָהָם יג- מִימֵי
קֶדֶם:"

which are specified in the verses in Micha (7:18-20): “1- Who is like you Hashem, 2- who pardons iniquity 3- and overlooks transgression 4- to those who remain from His heritage, 5- He does not hold onto His anger forever 6- since He desires to do kindness. 7- He will again have mercy on us, 8- He will suppress our iniquities, 9- and He will cast into the depth of the sea all of our sins. 10- He will give truth

² (זֶהר חֶלֶק א' א, י"ג מִדּוֹת הָרַחֲמִים).

to Yaakov, 11- and kindness to Avraham, 12- as he swore to our forefathers 13- from days long ago."

וְשֶׁבֶפְסוּק (תִּשְׁאָא לך, ו־ז) "א- ה' ה' אֵל
ב- רַחוּם ג- וְחֲנוּן ד- אֶרֶךְ ה- אֲפִים ו- וְרַב־
חֶסֶד ז- וְאֵמֶת, ח- נָצַר חֶסֶד ט- לְאַלְפִים י-
נִשְׂא עֹון יא- וְפָשַׁע יב- וְחִטָּאָה יג- וְנָקָה:",

And as specified in slightly different format in the verses in Parshas Ki Sisa: **"1- Hashem, Hashem, the G-d 2- who is merciful 3- and gracious, 4- who takes a long time 5- to get angry, 6- and does a great amount of kindness 7- and truth. 8- He keeps His kindness 9- for thousands of generations, 10- He forgives iniquity 11- and transgression 12- and sin 13- and He cleanses."**

שְׁמִשָּׁם הוּא מְקוֹר הַתְּשׁוּבָה,

That from these attributes of Mercy of Hashem **is the source of** our ability **to do teshuva,**

לְהִיּוֹת "נוֹשֵׂא עֹון כו" (תִּשְׁאָא שָׁם.
מִיכָּה שָׁם).

which will cause Hashem **to "forgive our iniquities" etc.**

In other words, these thirteen attributes of mercy aren't just about forgiving us, but more importantly they are about giving us the power to do teshuva, and when we do teshuva then Hashem will certainly forgive us.

וְהֵם הַמִּתְגַּלִּים בְּרֵאשׁ-חֹדֶשׁ אֱלוּל, שָׁאז
הוּא בְּחִינַת עֵת רְצוֹן³.

And these attributes of mercy **become revealed** starting **on Rosh Chodesh Elul, which is a time of "good will" of Hashem.**

כִּי מֵרֵאשׁ-חֹדֶשׁ אֱלוּל עַד אַחֵר יוֹם-
הַכִּפּוּרִים הֵם מ' יוֹם שְׁעָלָה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ
עָלִי-הַשָּׁלוֹם לְמָרוֹם לְקַבֵּל לוֹחוֹת
הָאַחֲרוֹנוֹת.

This is because from Rosh Chodesh Elul until after Yom Kippur are the forty days that Moshe Rabeinu went up to heaven to receive the second set of Luchos (Tablets).

³ (רֵאָה טוֹר אוֹרַח חַיִּים סִימָן תַּקפ"א וּפְרִיָּשָׁה שָׁם).

וַיְמַחֵם ה' אֶת־הָרָשׁוֹנִים בְּרָצוֹן כו'.⁴ And just like the first forty days that Moshe went up to receive the first set of Luchos **was a time when Hashem was happy with the Jewish People**, since it is before they sinned with the making of the golden calf, so too when Moshe went up to receive the second Luchos was a time when Hashem was happy with the Jewish People and was ready to forgive them.

Moshe went up Mount Sinai to spiritually ascend to heaven three separate times of 40 days each: 1) to receive the first Luchos, 2) after the sin of the golden calf Moshe went up for 40 days to ask Hashem not to destroy the Jewish People, 3) to receive the second Luchos and have Hashem grant complete forgiveness to the Jewish People.

We derive this from the verse (Devarim 10:10): “And I stood on the mountain for 40 days and 40 night just like the first days, and Hashem also listened to me then and did not want to destroy you.” This means that just like the first days that Moshe was on Mount Sinai was when Hashem was happy with us, so too the last time Moshe was on the mountain and Hashem gave complete forgiveness to the Jewish People was a time when Hashem was happy with us. These last 40 days were from Rosh Chodesh Elul until Yom Kippur, since Yom Kippur was when Hashem completely forgave us and gave us the second Luchos.

וַיְהִי שֶׁכָּתוּב "הַרְוֵעָה בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים" אֶצְלִי
 "אֲנִי לְדוֹדִי וְדוֹדִי לִי" - שֶׁהוּא רִאשִׁי-
 תִּיבוֹת אֶלּוּל.⁵ And this is the idea that the verse places “nourishing me with roses” next to “אֲנִי-I am לְדוֹדִי-to my Beloved וְדוֹדִי-and my Beloved לִי-is to me”, which is an acronym for the word **אֶלּוּל-Elul**, since the month of Elul is when Hashem nourishes

⁴ ("וְאֲנֹכִי עֲמַדְתִּי בְּהָר פְּנִימִים הָרִאשֹׁנִים וְגו'") (עֲקֵב י, י) - "מָה הָרִאשֹׁנִים בְּרָצוֹן אִם הָאֲחֵרִים בְּרָצוֹן" / רַש"י תְּשׂא לָג, יא. עֲקֵב ט, יח).

⁵ (רַש"י תִּיבוֹת אֶלּוּל: אֲבֹדְרָהֶם סֹדֶר תְּפִלַּת רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה. רִאשִׁית חֲכֻמָּה שֶׁעַר הַתְּשׁוּבָה פָּרָק ד. פְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים שֶׁעַר רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה פָּרָק א. ב"ח לְטוֹר שָׁם. שֶׁל"ה מִסְכַּת רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה, "נִרְמָזָה").

me with His 13 attributes of mercy, represented by the rose that has 13 petals.

וְצִירֶךָ לְהַבִּין: מֵהוּ עֲנִין "י"ג מִדּוֹת
הַרַחֲמִים" בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֱלוּל?

We need to understand: What is the idea of the “13 Attributes of Mercy” in the month of Elul?

בְּשִׁלְמָא בְּעֶשְׂרֵת יָמֵי תְּשׁוּבָה, יִתְבַּן⁶
שֶׁהֵם יָמֵי סְלִיחָה וּמַחֲלָה,

It makes sense to say that Hashem shows us His mercy **in the 10 Days of Teshuva** between Rosh Hashana and Yom Kippur, **since they are days of pardon and forgiveness.** Since that is when Hashem judges us for our deeds, we need Hashem’s mercy to forgive our misdeeds and judge us favorably then.

וְלִכְךָ אוֹמְרִים בְּעֶשְׂרֵת יָמֵי תְּשׁוּבָה
"וַיַּעֲבֵר ה' עָלֵינוּ וַיִּקְרָא ה' וכו'"
(תְּשׂא לך, ו).

And therefore, we say in the Selichos prayer service **during the 10 Days of Teshuva**⁷ (Shemos 3:6): **“And Hashem passed before Moshe, and Moshe called out: Hashem, Hashem, Merciful G-d, etc.”**

Meaning, the 13 Attributes of Mercy are mentioned every day during the ten days of Teshuva, since we need Hashem’s mercy to forgive us and judge us favorably.

But Elul is the time before any judgement is passed, so in what way is Hashem’s mercy expressed then?

וְהָעֲנִין הוּא: The idea is as follows:

⁶ [משום].

⁷ In most Ashkenazi communities Selichos prayers are recited during the 10 Days of Teshuva, and in those prayers we mention the 13 attributes of mercy. The Chabad custom is not to say Selichos during the 10 Days of Teshuva.

דְּהֵנָּה הַתְּשׁוּבָה אֵינָה עֲוֹנוֹת דִּוְקָא, **Teshuva is not only for actual sins,**
 שְׁהָרִי צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת "כָּל יָמָיו **since we are to spend "all of our**
 בַּתְּשׁוּבָה".⁸ **days with Teshuva"**. (Shabbos 153a)

It can't mean just correcting sins, for if we corrected our sins today then tomorrow we would not have any more Teshuva to do. Thus, Teshuva must be a lifestyle that we can experience every day, no matter how perfect our observance of Torah and Mitzvos may be.

אֶלֶּא בְּחִינַת תְּשׁוּבָה הוּא, שֶׁשָּׁב מִדְּרָכּוֹ **Rather, Teshuva means to return**
 הָרָאשׁוֹן. **(or change) from one's previous way of doing things.**

Meaning to turn from our mundane lifestyle to reconnect to our spiritual source in Hashem.

וּכְמוֹ שְׂאוּמְרִים:⁹ "וְהִחְזִירֵנוּ בַּתְּשׁוּבָה **Like we say in the Shemona Esrai**
 שְׁלִימָה לְפָנֶיךָ כו'". **prayer in the 5th blessing: "And**
bring us back with complete
returning (Teshuva) לְפָנֶיךָ-before
You". Later in the maamar the Alter Rebbe will explain the meaning of returning 'לְפָנֶיךָ-before You'.

1. Before we can understand the idea of Hashem's mercy in Elul, we need to understand the idea of Teshuva in general, and how that applies to Elul.
2. To understand the idea of Teshuva, we first need to explain the difference between Torah study and Mitzva observance, and how Teshuva is deeper than both of them.
3. To understand the difference between Torah study and Mitzvah observance we need to explain two different modes of how Hashem reveals Himself: in an encompassing manner, and in an internal manner. These two modes of Hashem's expression will be reflected in the difference between Mitzvos and Torah.

⁸ (שְׁבֶת קִנְג, א).

⁹ (נוֹסֵחַ תְּפִילַת הָעֶמֶד).

4. The difference between Mitzvos and Torah is also expressed in an “argument” between the Sages, one saying that Torah study is greater, and one saying that fulfilling Mitzvos is greater.

First, the Alter Rebbe will cite the argument regarding which is greater: Torah or Mitzvos, and use that as a starting point to explain the difference between Hashem’s encompassing light and internalized light. Then he will explain how that gives us a greater insight into the nature of Teshuva, and thereby, a greater insight into the nature of Elul.

וּבִיאֹר הָעֲנִין: The explanation is as follows:

הִנֵּה בְּדַבְרֵי חַז"ל¹⁰ יֵשׁ ב' דְּעוֹת, אֶחָד אוֹמֵר: "תִּלְמוּד גָּדוֹל", וְאֶחָד אוֹמֵר: "מַעֲשֵׂה גָדוֹל".

We find two opinions among our Sages, one says that “Torah study is greater than fulfilling Mitzvos”, and one says that “Fulfilling Mitzvos is greater than studying Torah”.

וְנִמְנוּ וְגִמְרוּ: תִּלְמוּד גָּדוֹל - שְׂמִיבִיא לִידֵי מַעֲשֵׂה.

They (all the sages present) took a vote and concluded that “Torah study is greater since it leads to the fulfillment of the Mitzvos.” (Kidushin 40b)

In order to fulfill any Mitzvah, a person first needs to learn how to fulfill the Mitzvah. Since all Mitzvas need Torah study before they can happen, therefore Torah study is greater. It leads to the fulfillment of all the Mitzvos.

וְלִהְיוֹן עֲנִין מַחֲלֻקוֹתָם, וּבִמְאִי קָא מִיפְלָגִי?

We need to understand the idea behind their debate. What exactly do they disagree about?

What difference is there which one is greater? In the end, we are required to both study Torah and fulfill Mitzvos either way. Also, what is the reasoning behind each opinion?

¹⁰ (סוף פֶּרֶק קָמָא דְקִדּוּשִׁין)

יֵשׁ לְהַקְדִּים לְהַבִּין תַּחֲלָה מֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב

Before we explain the idea of this debate about Torah and Mitzvos, **we first need to understand the following** contradiction between verses:

(יִרְמְיָה כג, כד): "אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ אֲנִי מְלֵא",

One verse says (Yirmiyahu 23:24): **"I (Hashem) fill the heavens and the earth."**

וְהֵלֵא כְּתִיב (יֵשַׁעְיָה ו, ג): "מְלֵא כָּל הָאָרֶץ כְּבוֹדוֹ" -

But somewhere else it is written (Yeshaya 6:3): **"The whole earth is full of His glory."**

וְלֹא נִזְכָּר "שָׁמַיִם". וְגַם, שֵׁשׁ נֶאֱמַר "אֲנִי מְלֵא" וְכֵן כְּתִיב "כְּבוֹדוֹ".

In this verse the word "heavens" are not mentioned, and also in the other verse it says "I (Hashem) fill (the heavens etc.)", but here it's written only "His glory (fills the earth)"?

We have two questions: 1) Why does the first verse mention the heavens and earth, and the second verse only mentions the earth? 2) Why does the first verse refer to Hashem while the second verse only refers to His glory?

אָךְ הִנֵּה יָדוע¹¹, דִּישׁ 'מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין' וְ'סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין':

However, the explanation of these two verses will be based on **the known concept** that Hashem is expressed in two ways: **There is "מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין" - Hashem fills all worlds** and there is **"סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין" - Hashem encompasses all worlds**:

וּפִירוּשׁ 'מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין' הוּא:

The explanation of "מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין" - Hashem fills all worlds" is:

¹¹ (זֶהָר חֵלֶק רַבָּה, א: "אִיהוּ סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין . . אִיהוּ מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין").

בְּחִינַת הָאֶרֶץ הָאֱלֹהִים הַנִּמְשָׁךְ
בְּנִבְרָאִים לְהַחְיֹתָם מִ"עֲשֶׂה
מֵאֲמֹרוֹת": "יְהִי אוֹר כו'" (בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ג),
"בְּדִבְרֵי ה' כו'" (תְּהִלִּים לג, ו),

It is the aspect of Hashem's revelation which is drawn into the created beings to give them life. It comes from the Ten Statements with which Hashem spoke and created the world, as it says in Bereishis (1:3) that "Hashem said: **'Let there be light'**", and the light came into being." It also says in Tehillim (33:6) that **"with the words of Hashem** the heavens were created."

שֶׁהוּא מְתַלַּב בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָם וְתוֹךְ תוֹכָם
מִמֶּשֶׁ, שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ בְּקֶרֶבָם לְהִיּוֹת חַיּוֹת
לָהֶם, וְהוּא מֵתַחֲלֵק לַחֲלָקִים, לְהִיּוֹת
מִחִיָּה כָּל חֵד לְפֹנִם שִׁיעוּרָא דִּילִיָּה.

This revelation of life-force from Hashem becomes invested and incorporated into the very being and essence of the created beings. It goes into them to give them life. It varies in many different formats, in order that it give life to each created being according to its specific capacity and nature.

וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ מָשָׁל בְּגִשְׁמִיּוֹת - בְּדוֹמָם,
צוּמָח, חַי, מְדַבֵּר:

For example, in the physical world there are four levels of life: **inanimate objects** (like earth, water, and air), **vegetation**, **animal life**, and **human life**.

שֶׁהַדּוֹמָם, הַגִּם שֶׁנִּתְּהוּהָ גַם כֵּן
מִ"עֲשֶׂה מֵאֲמֹרוֹת", וְנִמְשָׁךְ בּוֹ גַם כֵּן
חַיּוֹת אֱלֻקוֹת מֵאוֹתוֹ הַמֵּאֲמָר כְּמוֹ
שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ חַיּוֹת אֱלֹהִים בְּצוּמָח וְחַי, מְכַל
מְקוֹם חַיּוֹתוֹ מְצוּמָצֵם זְעִיר זְעִיר;

The inanimate objects: even though they were also created from the Ten Statements that Hashem used to create the world, and they also receive their life-force from Hashem from the same "statements" of Hashem that the vegetation and animals receive life from, nonetheless the inanimate objects have extremely limited life-force, they only have enough life-

force to exist and take up space, but not to grow or move,

וְהַצִּימָח יֵשׁ בוֹ חַיּוּת יוֹתֵר; וְהָחַי –
יוֹתֵר גַּם מִן הַצִּימָח; וְהַמְדַּבֵּר – יוֹתֵר
כִּי¹².

whereas vegetation has more life-force than inanimate objects which enables it to grow, **and animals have more life-force** than vegetation which enables them to move around, **and people have even more life-force** than animals, which enables them to think and understand and communicate etc.

וּלְפִי עֵרֶךְ זֶה, גַּם בְּעוֹלָמוֹת הָרוּחָנִיִּים
יֵשׁ הִתְחַלְקוֹת מַדְרָגוֹת רַבּוֹת, וּלְכוֹלָם
נִמְשָׁךְ חַיּוּת מְשׁוּנָה וְנִבְדָּל מִחַיּוֹת
הַנִּמְשָׁךְ לְזוּלָתוֹ.

Just like it is in the physical world that Hashem's life-force is expressed in many different levels and formats, **so too in the spiritual worlds there are many different levels, and there is drawn into each one a specific life-force which is separate and different than the life-force which is drawn into a different level.**

וְהֵינּוּ מִמַּדַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, שֶׁהוּא
הַנִּקְרָא 'מַמְלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין', שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ
בְּתוֹךְ תוֹךְ הָעוֹלָמוֹת מִמָּשׁ.

This internalized revelation of Hashem's life-force **comes from the aspect of Hashem's Malchus-Kingship, which is also called “מַמְלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין”** Hashem fills all worlds”, since it is this aspect that becomes invested into the very being and essence of all the worlds.

In Tanya part 2 chapter 7 it is explained that Hashem can only be a King if there are created beings who feel themselves as separate from Him and accept on themselves His Kingship. Therefore, it is Hashem's aspect of Kingship that is directly involved in the creation of the world, creating beings that feel themselves independent of Hashem and then nullify their ego to Him. Since

¹² (גם מן החי).

Hashem's aspect of Kingship is directly involved in their creation, it is also referred to as "ממלא כל עולמין" - Hashem fills all worlds", since it is specifically through this aspect that Hashem's life-force become directly drawn forth and internalized.

אבל בחינת 'סובב כל עולמין' הוא:

However, the aspect of "סובב כל עולמין" - Hashem encompasses all worlds" is different as follows:

בחינת השפעה והארת אלקות שאינו נמשך ונתלבש בתוך העולמות בבחינת גילוי, להיות מושג בהשגתם, אלא הוא בבחינת מקיף עליהם מלמעלה.

It is the aspect of Hashem's expression and light that is not drawn into the worlds in a revealed manner which they can grasp, rather it encompasses them from beyond their perception.

ועל כן נקרא 'סובב כל עולמין', שסובב לכולם בשווה, שאין בו התחלקות, מאחר שאינו מתלבש בבחינת גילוי בהשגה, שיתכן לומר שלזה הוא מאיר ומתגלה כך ולזה כך כו'.

It is therefore called "סובב כל עולמין" - Hashem encompasses all worlds" since it encompasses all the worlds equally. It does not vary, since it is not invested in the worlds in a revealed and perceptible manner, in which case it would be experienced differently by each level and aspect of creation, whereas this expression of Hashem which is not directly perceptible is equally hidden from all worlds.

ועל כן הוא "שוה ומשוה כו"¹³.

It therefore is equally present on all levels, from highest to lowest.

ובו הוא שנאמר: "את השמים ואת הארץ אני מלא", דהיינו בחינת 'סובב כל עולמין', דלית אתר פנוי מיניה"¹⁴.

It is regarding this aspect of Hashem's expression that the verse says: "I (Hashem) fill the heavens and the earth", meaning the aspect of "סובב כל עולמין" - Hashem

¹³ ("קטן וגדול". פיוט "וכל מאמינים" בתפילת מוסף דראש השנה ויום הכפורים).

¹⁴ (תקוני זהר תקון נז. עמוד צא, ב).

encompasses all worlds”, since as it says in the Zohar “there is no place empty of Him”.

The expression of Hashem that is beyond the limitations of the worlds is equally present in the “heavens”, meaning the world of Atzilus, and in the earth, meaning in the worlds created through Hashem’s aspect of Kingship. This expression of Hashem demonstrates that Hashem is equally present in all levels and aspects of existence.

ומה שכתוב "מלא כל הארץ כבודו"
הוא בחינת 'ממלא כל עלמין' -
שנקרא "כבוד".

The verse which says, “the whole earth is full of His glory” is referring to the aspect of **“ממלא כל עלמין”** - **Hashem fills all worlds” which is called “His glory”.**

The revelation of Hashem that can be grasped and internalized is called Hashem’s glory, since through this limited expression of Hashem the created beings can have some understanding about Hashem’s “glory”, i.e. His existence and great accomplishments in creating and guiding the worlds. (Like our Sages say: Hashem’s humility is expressed in the fact that He makes some of His greatness understandable to the created beings”.)

Now we have the answer to the two questions asked above: 1) the reason the first verse said that Hashem fills “the heavens and the earth” is because it is referring to **“סובב כל עלמין”** - Hashem encompasses all worlds” equally, and the second verse that mentions only the earth is because it is referring to **“ממלא כל עלמין”** - Hashem fills all worlds” in an internal manner, and this type of life-force is not the same in the heaven and on earth, but is specific to every created being.¹⁵ 2) the reason the first verse says that **“I (Hashem) fill the heavens and earth”** is because it’s referring to **“סובב כל עלמין”** - Hashem encompasses all

¹⁵ Perhaps the reason it mentions the “earth” specifically is because “earth” is also an allusion to Malchus-Kingship. “Earth”, meaning the ground, is the lowest level which everyone steps on, but at the same time everything receives life from it, for all vegetation grows from it. Similarly, Malchus is the lowest level of Hashem’s modes of expression, but nonetheless all the creates beings only exist and live through Malchus. Thus, the meaning of “all the earth is full of His glory” is that all the levels created from Malchus (the “earth” of the world of Atzilus) are filled and permeated internally with Hashem’s revelation of life-force. See Tanya, Igeres HaKodesh, letter 8.

worlds”, which is revealing how Hashem Himself is higher than the limitations of all the worlds and is found equally in all levels, and the second verse only says that “His **glory**” fills the earth, since “מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין” Hashem fills all worlds” is only a limited expression of Hashem’s life-force that is compatible as the existence power and life of the various creations.¹⁶

וְהֵנָּה אָמְרוּ רַ"ל (אבות ו, ג): "אֵין כְּבוֹד
אֶלָּא תוֹרָה"¹⁷,

Now, our Sages have said that “the only true glory is the Torah”.

וְהֵינּוּ מְשׁוּם "דְּאוּרֵייתָא מִחֻכְמָה
נִפְקֶת"¹⁸,

This is because “the Torah comes from Hashem’s Chochma-Wisdom”.

שְׂמֻחַ חֻכְמָה נִמְשָׁכִים "ל"ב נְתִיבוֹת"¹⁹.

And from Chochma-Wisdom comes “32 paths”:

וְכַמְּשַׁל הַנְּתִיב וְהַשְּׁבִיל, שֶׁעָשׂוּי לַעֲבוֹר
בּוֹ מִמָּקוֹם לְמָקוֹם –

Meaning, that just like the analogy of a path and a road which is made for travelling from one place to another place,

כֵּן מִבְּחִינַת חֻכְמָה-עֵילָא נִמְשָׁכַת
הַשְּׁפָעָה בְּבִחִינַת הַתְּחַלְקוֹת, לְהִיּוֹת
'מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין',

so too, from the aspect of the Higher level of Chochma there is drawn forth an expression from Hashem which varies so that it can “fill all worlds” internally.

¹⁶ Note that both verses use the word מלא, meaning to fill. Both say Hashem fills the world. The only difference is in terms of revelation. מלא כל עלמין is the revealed aspect of His presence, and סובב כל עלמין is Hashem’s Light beyond our comprehension and perception, but both are present in all worlds simultaneously. They are just different ways Hashem constantly “fills” the world.

¹⁷ (ועיין מה שנתבאר על פסוק “כִּי עַל כָּל כְּבוֹד חוּפָּה” (לְקַמֵּן שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים מו, ב)).

¹⁸ (זהר חלק ב תרומה קבא, א).

¹⁹ (ספר יצירה בתחילתו).

עד שיומשך בגשמיות ממש, בפרטות
דיני התורה, כשר ופסול כו'.

So drastically does it vary from its origin **that it goes into the actual physical world as the specific laws of the Torah, determining what is Kosher to be eaten or used for a mitzva, and what is invalid to be eaten or used for a mitzva etc.,**

שהם בענינים גשמיים, תרומות
ומעשרות כו' וכןודע

These mitzvos involve physical objects, like Terumos and Maasros²⁰, as is known.

When it comes to the Chochma of the Torah, Hashem's sublime will and wisdom descend and vary until they become understandable laws and concepts to us. Just like a path upon which one travels a long distance, in the Torah we see how Hashem's will and wisdom traveled from the abstract spiritual principle to the concrete physical application. Thus, the Torah corresponds to "ממלא כל עולם" - Hashem fills all worlds", since it descends to us in a way that we can internalize and experience. This is why the Torah is called "glory" and "honor"; it addresses our level of understanding, enabling us to appreciate something of the glory and honor of Hashem.

אבל על ידי המצות, נמשך גילוי אור
מבחינת 'סובב כל עולם', שהוא
בחינת המקיף.

However, Mitzvos draw down a revelation of Divine Light in the manner of "סובב כל עולם"-Hashem encompasses all worlds". It is an encompassing Light.

והענין:

The idea is as follows:

כי הנה ידוע שהתורה נעשה מזון
לנפש האלקית.

It is known that Torah study becomes nourishment for the Divine soul.

²⁰ Terumos: The mitzva to give the first of the harvest to the Kohen. Maasros: The mitzva to give a tenth of the harvest to the Levites (Leviim); then another tenth goes to the poor or is eaten in Yerushalayim, depending on the year.

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב (תהלים מ, ט): "וְתוֹרַתְךָ
בְּתוֹךְ מִעֵי",

Like it is written (Tehillim 40:9):
“And Your Torah is in my
innards”.

שֶׁהוּא כְּמוֹ עַל דֶּרֶךְ מִשַּׁל הַמְּזוֹן,
שֶׁנִּכְנָס בְּתוֹךְ תוֹךְ הָאָדָם, וְנַעֲשֶׂה חַיּוֹת
בְּפָנִימִיּוֹתוֹ –

It is analogous to food that goes
deep inside of a person and gives
him life from within.

וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה נִמְשָׁךְ גִּילּוֹי הָאֶרֶת
הַחֲכָמָה, לְהִיּוֹת מוֹשָׁג בְּהַשָּׁגָה מִמֶּשׁ,
“וְאֲשִׁים דְּבָרֵי בְּפִיךָ” (ישעיה נא, טז).

So too, the Torah draws down a
revelation of the Light of Divine
Chochma that goes into our actual
understanding, like it says
(Yeshaya 51:16): “And I (Hashem)
have placed my words (of the
Torah) in your mouth.”

Just like a person puts food in their mouth and eats it, the Divine soul “eats” Torah when studying it. That’s why the verse says the Torah words are placed in our mouth.

וְהֵינּוּ מִבְּחִינַת ‘מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין’ –
שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּעֲלָמִין בְּבָחִינַת פְּנִימִיּוֹת
מִמֶּשׁ.

This is the aspect of “מְמַלֵּא כָּל
עֲלָמִין - Hashem fills all worlds”: it
becomes invested in the worlds and
actually internalized.

אֲבָל הַמִּצְוֹת נַעֲשִׂים לְבוּשִׁים לְנַפֵּשׁ-
הָאֱלֹקִית²¹,

In contrast, the Mitzvos become
“garments” for the Divine soul.

שֶׁהוּא כְּמוֹ עַל דֶּרֶךְ מִשַּׁל הַלְּבוּשׁ – הוּא
עַל גּוֹף הָאָדָם מְלַמְעָלָה וְאֵינוֹ נִכְנָס
בְּפָנִימִיּוֹתוֹ,

It is analogous to a garment; it
covers the body but doesn’t go
inside it.

וְכֵן הַהִמְשָׁכָה הַנִּמְשָׁכֶת עַל יְדֵי
הַמִּצְוֹת הוּא בְּבָחִינַת מְקִיף, מִפְּנֵי
שֶׁהִיא מִבְּחִינַת ‘סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין’,
שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלָּה מִהַשָּׁגָה.

Similarly, the revelation drawn
down by the Mitzvos is something
encompassing, in a manner of
“סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין”-encompassing all
worlds”. It is beyond our grasp.

²¹ (זהר חלק ב, ויקהל רי, א).

וְעַל כֵּן הַלְבוּשִׁים יוֹתֵר יְקָרִים בְּטִבְעָם
מִהַמְזוֹן, לְהִיּוֹת שְׂבִשְׂרָשָׁם הֵם יוֹתֵר
נְעִלִים.²²

That is why garments are naturally more expensive than food. In their spiritual source, they are higher.

וְזֶהוּ שְׂכָתוֹב בַּמִּצְוֹת (תְּבוֹא כח, מז):
"תַּחַת אֲשֶׁר לֹא עֲבַדְתָּ כו' מְרֹב כָּל",

And this is the meaning of what is written regarding the Mitzvos (Devarim 28:47): "Since you did not serve Hashem with joy and gladness of heart **more than from having רב כל** - an abundance of all good things, that is why you are in exile serving your enemies."

פִּירוּשׁ: "רב כל" הוּא בְּחִינַת גֵּן-עֵדֶן,²³
הַשְּׂגַת אֱלֻקוּת;

The deeper meaning behind "רב כל - an abundance of all good things" is the level Gan Eden (the spiritual Garden of Eden), which is about perceiving Hashem's revelation.

שְׂהַמְצוֹת הֵם יוֹתֵר גְּבוּהִים, שֶׁהֵם
מְבַחֲשִׁינָה מִקִּיפִים - שְׁלִמְעֵלָה מִגֵּן עֵדֶן,
שֶׁהוּא הַשְּׂגָה בְּבַחֲשִׁינַת פְּנִימִיּוּת.

We do the Mitzvos with more joy than the joy of being in Gan Eden because the Mitzvos are much higher than Gan Eden, since they come from the encompassing Light of Hashem. This is higher than Gan Eden which is a level of Hashem's revelation that we can understand and internalize.

וּמַצִּד זֶה אָמַר הָאוֹמֵר: מַעֲשֵׂה גְדוֹל מִן
הַתְּלִמּוּד.

It is because of this advantage of Mitzvos that one opinion in the Gemara said that: "Doing Mitzvos is greater than Torah study".

²² [וְעֵינֵינוּ מֵה שֶׁנִּתְבָּאָר מִזֶּה בְּדִבּוּר הַמֵּתַחִיל "מִזְמוֹר שִׁיר תְּנוּכַת הַבַּיִת" (לְקַמֵּן, בְּרָכָה צח, ד), בְּעֵנֵינוּ ג' בְּחִינּוֹת "מְזוֹן, לְבוּשׁ, בַּיִת"].

²³ [עֵינֵינוּ מֵה שֶׁנִּתְבָּאָר בְּדִבּוּר הַמֵּתַחִיל "וְאַתָּה תַּעֲצֹה" (תוֹרָה אור תַּעֲצֹה פא, ב)].

אך אף על פי כן "נמנו וגמרו: תלמוד גדול - שמביא לידי מעשה".

Nonetheless, "they voted and decided that Torah study is greater, since it brings the person to fulfill the Mitzvos."

והענין: כי אי אפשר להיות התעוררות המשכת 'סובב כל עולמין' על ידי המצות מעשיות - שהם מדברים גשמיים: ציצית מצמר, צדקה במזון גשמי -

The reason is: It is impossible to cause the expression of Hashem's Light that "סובב כל עולמין" to be drawn down into the Mitzvos that are fulfilled with physical objects, like Tzitzis from wool, charity given from physical money, etc. ...

אם לא על ידי התורה, שהיא הממוצע המחברם.

except through the Torah which is the intermediary that connects them

The spiritual revelation of the Mitzvos that "encompasses all worlds" and the physical objects used for Mitzvos are incompatible. The Torah connects them because on the one hand it is a spiritual knowledge about Hashem, but on the other hand it is expressed on our physical level of understanding and application. This is why Torah study has an advantage over Mitzvos; even the Mitzvos need the Torah in order for their own Divine Light to be revealed.

וכמו על דרך משל באדם, שהדבור הוא הממוצע המחבר ומוציא העלים המחשבה לידי גילוי כו' :

This is analogous to the power of speech in a person, which serves as a connection between a person's concealed thoughts and others, revealing one's thoughts to other people.

From one's internal perspective, speech is lower than thought, since one needs to limit and contain his thoughts in words in order to express them as speech. Nonetheless the power of speech has an advantage over thought, since it has the power to reveal his ideas to other people. So, from other people's perspective, speech is more important since it can be understood, whereas thoughts remain hidden and inaccessible.

So too, even though from the perspective of Above to below Torah study is lower than Mitzvos, since it is a limited revelation of Hashem's will and

wisdom that limited people can understand, whereas Mitzvos are an expression of the unlimited “encompassing” Light of Hashem, nonetheless from our perspective from below to Above Torah study is higher since we can actually grasp it and internalize it. Therefore, from our perspective Torah study has an advantage over Mitzvos since we can only appreciate Mitzvos and experience them internally through Torah study.



Summary of Part 1 of the *Maamar*

Q1 The month of Elul is represented by the verse “לְדוֹדִי-I am to my Beloved וְדוֹדִי-and my Beloved לִי-is to me”, which is an acronym for the word Elul-אֶלּוּל. The same verse in Shir Hashirim also says that Hashem nourishes us with “roses”. What is the connection?

A1 The “roses” here are the kind that have 13 petals that represent Hashem’s 13 Attributes of Mercy, and starting in Elul (until Yom Kippur) is when Hashem’s 13 Attributes of Mercy are revealed to us.

Q2 How do we see Hashem’s mercy expressed in Elul? During the time between Rosh Hashana and Yom Kippur we need Hashem’s mercy to judge us favorably and forgive our sins, but in the month of Elul no judgement is being made, so in what way do we see Hashem’s mercy?

A2 The Alter Rebbe will answer later in the maamar that Hashem’s mercy is expressed in giving us the power to do Teshuva. But first, he explains the idea of Teshuva in general. To understand the greatness of Teshuva, he first explains the difference between Torah study and Mitzva observance. The difference between Mitzvos and Torah corresponds to the difference between Hashem’s “encompassing Light” and His “Light that becomes internalized” and directly experienced in created beings.

Q3 What is the difference between the verse “I fill the heavens and earth” and the verse “the whole earth is full of His glory”?

A3 The first verse is describing how Hashem's encompassing Light equally fills the heavens and earth without any distinction, just like Hashem is equally found everywhere. The second verse is describing Hashem's Light that varies according to the capacity of every individual creation to receive, giving it a particular existence and life. This Light is something each creature can understand according to its capacity, and it provides a perception of the glory and greatness of Hashem. (Whereas the encompassing Light doesn't directly reveal Hashem's glory since it is above our perception.)

Q4 What is the advantage of Torah study over Mitzva performance, and the advantage of Mitzva performance over Torah study?

A4 The advantage of Torah study is that comes down into our understanding and feeling, and becomes "food" for the Divine soul, giving it life internally. This is because it comes from Hashem's Light that becomes revealed and internalized to each creature and person individually. The advantage of the Mitzvos is that they connect us to Hashem's encompassing Light which is beyond all limitations, and they become the "garments" for the Divine soul, allowing it to connect to the infinite greatness of Hashem. However, Torah study has an additional advantage, that even the Mitzvos need the Torah study to reveal the connection to Hashem that they accomplish.

Lessons in the Service of Hashem from Part 1 of the *Maamar*

1. Hashem is found everywhere; in all times and situations He is equally present. This means that there can't be any situation in our life that has no connection to Hashem, that is just by mistake or coincidence, or that is completely mundane and physical. Since the truth is that Hashem is everywhere, that means that in every situation Hashem is present and is giving us a way to connect to Him.
2. Hashem reveals Himself distinctively to every created being according to its capacity. That means that Hashem is not only creating us and giving us life, but He is really teaching and interacting with us on a personal level. Each person can recognize that Hashem is personally involved with him or her and is both teaching and guiding them throughout life. All that we need is to keep our eyes open to see.
3. When we learn Torah, it becomes our very life. Not only do we understand the Torah as a subject and follow its instructions, but it becomes the focus of everything that our life is about. The way we think about everything in our life: our family, our career, our health etc., all is seen through the lens of the Torah's perspective, and the Torah gives everything spiritual depth and meaning. Through the Torah we become aware of how to connect to Hashem in every situation; how to truly live at every moment with Hashem.
4. Even though Mitzvos give us the ultimate connection to the infinite greatness of Hashem, even they need the Torah study to reveal that connection. When we study about the Mitzvos and how they connect us to Hashem, this enable us to actually experience some of that infinite connection in our conscious mind and feelings.

Part 2

In the previous chapter of this maamar, the Alter Rebbe asked how Hashem's mercy is expressed in the month of Elul. Before answering, the Alter Rebbe explained at length the difference between Torah study and Mitzva performance, and how they correspond to two ways that Hashem reveals Himself: 1) By "encompassing all worlds" equally, and His true Being existing everywhere; 2) By "filling all worlds" internally by giving each creation personalized existence and life according to what it can grasp. Through Torah we connect to Hashem's internally revealed Light, and through Mitzvos we connect to the "encompassing" Light of Hashem.

To explain the idea that Mitzvos connect us to the "encompassing" Light of Hashem the Alter Rebbe explains the general idea that this "encompassing" Light is more expressed in the physical world than in the spiritual world, which is one reason that Mitzvos can only be performed in the physical world.

This is also why Teshuva can only be done in the physical world and not in the spiritual world, since the power to do Teshvua also comes from the "encompassing" Light. (However, the power for Teshuva comes from a deeper level in the encompassing Light than the level that Mitzvos derive from, which is why Teshvua can correct the blemish caused by the lack of Mitzvos.)

ב. Chapter 2.

וְהָיָה כְּתִיב (וְאֶתְחַנֵּן ז', יא): "הַיּוֹם
לַעֲשׂוֹתָם", "הַיּוֹם" דְּוָקָא, שְׁבַע עוֹלָם-
הַזֶּה הוּא הַנִּקְרָא "עוֹלָם הַמַּעֲשֵׂה"²⁴,
וְיִכְוֹלִים לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה.

It is written (Devarim 7:11): "These are the Mitzvos that I command you **today to do them.**" Only "**today**" in this physical world which is called "**the world of action**" are we able to do Teshuva.

מִה שְׁאִין בֵּין בְּעוֹלָם-הַבָּא, הֵיכָּה כְּמוֹ
שֶׁהוּא - כִּךְ יִשְׁאָר, שְׁאִין לוֹ כֹּחַ לְהַפּוֹךְ
עַצְמוֹ מִכְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא,

This is not the case in the spiritual World to Come. There the person will remain as he is, and he is not able to transform himself from the way he is when he arrives in the World to Come.

²⁴ (עבודת ה' ד', ב' (ובפירוש רש"י): הַיּוֹם לַעֲשׂוֹתָם (בעולם הזה), וְלֹא לְמַחֵר לַעֲשׂוֹתָם (דאינו יכול לעשותם לעולם הבא)).

אם לא שִׁסְרוּ מִמֶּנּוּ הַ"לְבוּשִׁים
הַצּוֹאִים" עַל יְדֵי כֹף-הַקָּלַע כּו', אֲבָל
הוא עֲצָמוּ אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל.

Except his “dirty garments” of improper thought, speech, and action (garments of the soul) **will be removed from him through** the process called “**the slingshot**” where his soul is flung from spiritual awareness to physical awareness and back as a punishment for exiling his Divine soul in improper conduct, **but by himself he is not able** to change.

וְהַטָּעַם הוּא:

The reason for this is as follows:

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם-הַבָּא אָמְרוּ (בְּרִכּוֹת יז,
א): "יוֹשְׁבֵין וְנִהְיִין".

Regarding the spiritual World to Come the Sages said (Berachos 17a): “the souls **dwelt there and enjoy** the radiance of the Divine Presence”.

שֶׁהוּא לְפִי שְׁמִשְׁגִּים אֱלֻקוֹת בְּבַחֲיִנַת
הַשְּׁגָה וְגִילּוֹי מִמֶּשׁ,

This is because they perceive Hashem’s revelation in a way that they can actually understand,

וְאִם בֶּן, הוּא מְבַחֲיִנַת 'מִמְּלָא כָּל
עֲלָמִין' - שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּבַחֲיִנַת גִּילּוֹי,

which means that this revelation is of the type that “**מִמְּלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין**” and is invested in creations in a revealed manner.

וּבְבַחֲיִנַת 'מִמְּלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין' הוּא
בְּבַחֲיִנַת הַתְחַלְקוֹת בְּנִ"ל.

This aspect of how Hashem “**מִמְּלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין**” comes **varies** according to the individual nature of each creature, **as explained previously** in the maamar.

וְעַל כֵּן, אִם הוּא בְּבַחֲיִנַת זו, אֵי אִפְשָׁר
לוֹ לְהִפָּךְ לְבַחֲיִנַת אַחֶרֶת, אַחֲרֵי שֶׁהֵם
מְחוּלְקִים וְנִבְדָּלִים זֶה מִזֶּה, וְכָל אֶחָד
וְאֶחָד עַל מְקוֹמוֹ בָּא.

Therefore, since the soul in the World to Come **exists in this aspect** of Hashem’s revelation which “**מִמְּלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין**”, it is **impossible for him to change to a different level**, since everything

in that world is varied and different, and each thing has its own specific place.

Since everything there exists in its clearly defined level and category, nothing can change to become something other than it already is.²⁵

אַבֵּל בְּעוֹלָם-הָהָא יֵשׁ בְּחִינַת הָאֶרֶת
'סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין'.

However, in this physical world there is a revelation of how Hashem "סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין" encompasses all worlds",

וְאֵף עַל פִּי שֶׁהוּא בְּבִחִינַת הָעֵלָם,
שְׂאִינָם מְשִׁיגִים בּוֹ, מְכַל מְקוֹם פּוֹעֵל
הוּא כָּאֵן.

and even though it is hidden so we cannot perceive it, it nonetheless has an effect here in this physical world.

וּלְפִי שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת 'סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין',
שֶׁ"שְׂוָה וּמְשֻׁוּה", וְ"אִם צְדָקָתָ מֶה תִּתֵּן
לּוֹ כִּי" (איוב לה, ז) - וְעַל כֵּן יְכוּלִים
לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה.

Since there is an expression of how Hashem "סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין" encompasses all worlds", which is the same in all worlds and makes them all seem equal by comparison, even opposites like good and bad, like it says about this level (Iyov 35:7): "If you have acted righteously, what have you given Him (Hashem)?" since on this level all seems equal, therefore we are able to do Teshuva, and to change from bad to good.²⁶

²⁵ The analogy for this used in Chassidus is from a fetus: During the time of conception the gender of the fetus is not yet determined. Only after the first stage of gestation in the womb the gender of the fetus established. That is why at the very beginning of pregnancy one may pray for the baby to be a specific gender, but after 40 days into pregnancy it isn't appropriate. The gender is already established by then and should not be changed. The analogy is that in this physical world there are always open possibilities for change, but in the spiritual World to Come everything is already established and the soul can't change itself. (See Likutay Torah on Parshas Pinchus, in the first maamar.)

²⁶ Note that the concept that on a certain level good and bad seem equal to Hashem

שֶׁאֵף שֶׁהוּא כְּעֵת רָשָׁע גָּמור, וְהוּא
לְמִטָּה מְטָה, יָכוֹל לְהִתְהַפֵּךְ לְהִיט
צְדִיק גָּדוֹל, מִצַּד הָאֶרֶץ הַסּוֹבֵב כו'.²⁷

Even someone who is presently completely wicked and on the lowest level, can change himself to become a very righteous person, and this is possible because of the revelation of Hashem's encompassing Light in this world.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חֲז"ל (אָבוֹת ד', יז): "יָפָה
שָׁעָה אַחַת בְּתְשׁוּבָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים
בְּעוֹלָם-הַזֶּה מִכָּל חַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם-הַבָּא",

This is the meaning of what our Sages said (Pirkei Avos 4:17): "One hour of Teshuva and good deeds in this physical world is better than all of the life of the spiritual World to Come."

כִּי "חַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם-הַבָּא" הוּא רַק מִבְּחִינַת
'מִמְלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין', שֶׁהוּא עַל יְדֵי
גְבוּרוֹת וְצִמְצוּמִים - "בִּיּוֹד נִבְרָא
הָעוֹלָם-הַבָּא כו".²⁸

This is because "the life of the spiritual World to Come" is only from the aspect of how Hashem's revelation "מִמְלָא כָּל עֲלָמִין" -fills all worlds", which is expressed through limiting and restricting the Light to what each creature can handle, like it says (Menachos 29b): "The World to Come was created with the letter 'Yud'."

is not to be understood literally. Hashem Himself decided that He hates bad deeds and loves good deeds, and this is the ultimate truth. However, Hashem created a level where the difference between bad and good is not noticeable due to a revelation of Hashem's greatness that makes everything in all the worlds seem equal compared to it. The purpose of this level is 1) there must be a level on which unholiness is possible so we can choose to serve Hashem of our own free will, 2) there must be a level where good and bad are interchangeable so we can change from bad deeds to good deeds (and bad thoughts and feelings to good ones). This level that Hashem created is expressed mainly in this physical world.

²⁷ וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר בְּאִרְכּוּת, עַל פְּסוּק "צוֹ אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאִמְרַת אֱלֹהִים אֶת קִרְבָּנִי
לֶחֱמִי כו'" (לְקַמֵּן פְּנִיחָס עה, ג). עֵינֵי שָׁם.

²⁸ (מְנַחוֹת כט, ב).

Just like a 'י' is shaped like a dot, so too Hashem's Light had to be shrunk down to the smallest point in order to be internalized in each of us according to our capacity.

אָבֵל בְּתוֹרָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים בְּעוֹלָם־
הַזֶּה - הוּא מִבְּחִינַת 'סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין'.

However, the Torah and good deeds that we perform in this physical world are from the aspect of how Hashem's revelation "סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין-encompasses all worlds" equally beyond all limitations.

וְזֶהוּ עֵיקַר כְּוִונַת יְרִידַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ
לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּגוֹף הַחוּמְרִי, מְשׁוּם
שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם־הַזֶּה יֵשׁ הָאֶרֶת 'סוֹבֵב כָּל
עֲלָמִין', אֲשֶׁר לְזֹאת תּוֹכֵל לְבָרֵר וּלְהַפֵּךְ
מֵרָע לְטוֹב כו'.

This is the main purpose for which the divine soul came down to become invested into a physical body: only in this physical world is there an expression of how Hashem's revelation "סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין-encompasses all worlds" which enables it to refine and transform the animal soul and body from bad to good.

וּלְפִי עֶרֶךְ זֶה נּוֹתְנִים לְאָדָם שְׁנֵי חַיִּיו
בְּמִסְפָּר וְקִצְבָּה, לְזֶה ע' שָׁנָה וּלְזֶה פ'²⁹
כו' - הֵייוֹנוּ כְּפִי מִסְפָּר מַה שְּׁצָרִיךְ לְבָרֵר
וּלְהַפֵּךְ מֵרָע לְטוֹב כו'.

The number of years of life are allotted to each person according to this goal; to one person 70 years, to another person 80 years etc. according to the amount that he needs to refine and transform from the animal soul and body from bad to good.

שָׁכַל יוֹם מְבָרֵר וּמְהַפֵּךְ חֵלֶק אֶחָד, עַד
שֶׁבְּשְׁנֵי חַיִּיו נִשְׁלָם מַה שְּׁהִיָּה צָרִיךְ
לְבָרֵר - שֶׁבְּשִׁבְלִיל זֶה יֵרְדֶה הַנֶּפֶשׁ
לְעוֹלָם־הַזֶּה. :

Every day a person refines and transforms another portion, so that throughout the years of a person's life he completes what he needed to refine of everything for which the soul came down into this world.

²⁹ (תְּהִלִּים צ, י: "יָמֵי שְׁנוֹתֵינוּ בָּהֶם שְׁבָעִים שָׁנָה, וְאִם בְּגִבּוֹרֶת שְׁמוֹנִים שָׁנָה").

The Alter Rebbe explained how specifically because of Hashem's "encompassing Light" being expressed in this physical world, we are able to transform the body and animal soul from bad to good through Teshuva, Torah, and Mitzvos. The focus is on how Mitzvos can refine and transform the physical body and animal soul since Mitzvos are the recipients of the "encompassing Light". (Torah study, by contrast, exists in the spiritual world too, where the "encompassing Light" is not expressed as much.)

Now the Alter Rebbe will continue to explain that Teshuva derives not only from the same "encompassing Light" that Mitzvos come from, but from an even deeper level of Hashem. Teshuva can even fix and complete what was lacking from the Mitzvos:

ג. Chapter 3.

אך אם פגם על ידי איזו חטא, שהוריד
והמשיך חיות לסטרא אחרא, שלא
בירר והיפך כנ"ל כל מה שהיה צריך,

However, if the person creates spiritual blemishes through sin, thereby drawing down life-force from holiness into "the Side Opposite of holiness", and he didn't refine and transform what he needed to from the body and animal soul, as explained above how this the purpose of the G-dly soul's descent into this world,

על זה הוא ענין התשובה - "והחזירנו
בתשובה שלמה לפניך" 30.

it is for this situation that we were given the idea of Teshuva, like we say in the 5th bracha of the Shemona Esrai: "and bring us back with complete Teshuva before You".

והנה הגם שאמרו רז"ל (יומא פו, א):
"לא זז משם עד שמוחלין לו",

And even though our Sages said regarding Teshuva (Yoma 86a): "if someone sinned but then did Teshuva, before he moves from his place he is already forgiven",

³⁰ (נוסח תפלת שמונה עשרה).

הִנֵּה הָרִי מְכָל מְקוֹם אֵף שְׁמוּחֵלִין לוֹ,
הַחֲסָרוֹן בְּמְקוֹמוֹ עוֹמֵד, מֵה שֶׁלֹּא
הַשָּׁלִים הֵחֲמִשְׁכָּה שֶׁהִיא מִמְשִׁיךְ כּו'.

nonetheless, even though he is forgiven, there still remains lacking the accomplishment of the revelation of Hashem that he was supposed to reveal in the process of refining and transforming the body and animal soul.

The question is, even if Teshuva brings forgiveness, how does that help the fact that he didn't fulfill the purpose of why his G-dly soul came into this world, to reveal Hashem and transform the body and animal soul to holiness?

אֲךָ זֶהוּ עֲנִין הַתְּשׁוּבָה שְׁאֵנוּ מְבַקְּשִׁים:
"וְהַחֲזִירֵנוּ בְּתְשׁוּבָה שְׁלֵמָה לְפָנֶיךָ",
פִּירוּשׁ: "לְפָנֵינוּמִיּוֹתֶךָ",

However, this is the deeper aspect of Teshuva that we ask Hashem for when we say: "bring us back with complete Teshuva **“לְפָנֶיךָ-before You,”** the deeper meaning of **לְפָנֶיךָ** “literally: before You” is **“לְפָנֵינוּמִיּוֹתֶךָ-to Your innermost Essence”**,³¹

שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלָּה גַּם מִבְּחִינַת 'סוֹבֵב כָּל
עֲלָמִין', שְׁאֵינוֹ נִקְרָא סוֹבֵב וּמְקִיף אֶלָּא
לְגַבִּי 'עֲלָמִין', אֲבָל עֲצֻמּוֹתוֹ וּמֵהוּתוֹ
יִתְבָּרֵךְ הוּא לְמַעַלָּה גַּם מִזֶּה.

which is beyond even the level of how Hashem **“סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין”**-encompasses all worlds”, which only encompasses and surrounds limited worlds, but Hashem's Essence is totally beyond the whole idea of worlds, even to encompass them.

³¹ The word “לְפָנֶיךָ-before/in front of” is related to the word “פָּנִים-face” and the word “לְפָנִים-inside of”, since the word “פָּנִים-face” is both the front of the person and is also the connection point to the inside of the person, both physically (through the senses and through breathing and eating) and spiritually, through the face is how one communicates to the person and connects to their soul. Thus the word **לְפָנֶיךָ** which could mean “to your face” could also mean “to your inside”.

וְעַל יְדֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה, שִׁימָשִׁיךְ אֹר חֶדֶשׁ
עַל יְדֵי גִילּוֹי עֲצָמוֹתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, יִמְלֵא כָּל
הַפְּגָמִים וְהַחֲסְרוֹנוֹת כו'.

And through Teshuva the person draws down a new revelation from the Essence of Hashem which fills in all the blemishes and whatever was lacking in the revelation of Hashem.

אָךְ אִיךָ יָכוֹל הָאָדָם לְעוֹרֵר כָּל כֶּךָ
לְמַעַלְהָ בְּעֲצָמוֹתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ, לְהַמְשִׁיךְ
אֹר חֶדֶשׁ מִמֶּנּוּ!?

However, the question is: **How is it possible for a limited person to call forth from such a high level, from Hashem's Essence, to draw down from Him a new revelation?**

אָךְ עַל זֶה הוּא מְבַקֵּשׁ: "וְהִחְזִירֵנוּ
בְּתְשׁוּבָה כו'", "הֲשִׁיבֵנוּ אֵלֶיךָ"³²,

It is for this reason that we ask Hashem: “bring us back with complete Teshuva before you,” and like it says in Eicha (5:21): “Return us to You and we will return.”

כְּלוֹמֵר אַתָּה תַּעֲרָה עָלֵינוּ רוּחַ
מִמְרוֹם³³, וְתִשְׁפִּיעַ עָלֵינוּ רַחֲמִים רַבִּים
מִמְקוֹר הָרַחֲמִים, מִבְּחִינַת "י"ג
מְבִילִין", "מִי אֵל כְּמוֹךָ נוֹשֵׂא עוֹן כו'",
שִׁיְהִיּוֹ אֲנַחְנוּ יְכוּלִּים לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה.

Meaning, that You Hashem should pour on us a “spiritual awakening” from Above, and cause His abundant mercies to flow down to us from the Source of all mercies, from His 13 Attributes of Mercy, which are specified in the verse from Micha (7:18-20): “Who is like you G-d, who pardons iniquity etc,”³⁴ since this is what will give us the ability to do Teshuva.

³² (איכה ה, כא).

³³ (על פי ישעיה לב, טו: "יערה עלינו רוח ממרום").

³⁴ See part 1 of this maamar translation at the beginning for the complete list of the 13 Attributes of Mercy mentioned in the verses from Micha.

וְזֶהוּ עֲנִין הָאֶרֶץ "י"ג מְכִילִין דְּרַחֲמֵי"
בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֱלוּל, שֶׁהוּא הֶכְנָה שִׁיחֵיו
יְכוּלִים לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה, לְהִיּוֹת "אֲנִי
לְדוֹדִי כו'".

And this is the idea of the revelation of the 13 Attributes of Mercy in the month of Elul, it is a preparation that we should be able to do Teshuva, to be able to be in the mode of "אֲנִי לְדוֹדִי-I am connecting to Hashem whom I love".

וְאֵף שֶׁבְּכָל הַשָּׁנָה אוֹמְרִים³⁵ י"ג מִדּוֹת
הֶרַחֲמִים - "ה' ה' אֵל רַחוּם כו'" (תְּשָׂא
לד, ו) -

And even though the whole year we mention in the Tachanun prayer the 13 Attributes of Mercy as they are specified in the verses from Ki Sisa: "Hashem Hashem, G-d who is merciful etc.", so then what is special about the 13 Attributes of Mercy in the month of Elul in contrast to what is revealed the whole year?

הֵם רַק הֶרַחֲמָנוּת עַל חַיֵּי הַגּוּף בְּלָבָד,
אֲבָל "י"ג מְכִילִין דְּרַחֲמֵי" הַמְּאִירִים
בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֱלוּל, הֵם הֶרַחֲמִים עַל חַיֵּי
הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְעוֹרְרָהּ בְּתִשְׁבּוּבָה.

The answer is that **those** Attributes of Mercy learned out from the verses in Ki Sisa are **only Hashem's mercies for our physical life, however the 13 Attributes of Mercy** that we learn out from the verses in Micha **that shine in the month of Elul are Hashem's mercies for the life of our G-dly souls, which awaken them and empower them to do Teshuva.**³⁶

³⁵ (אַחֲרֵי שְׁמוֹנֶה עָשָׂר בְּשַׁחֲרִית וּבִמְנַחָה).

³⁶ The 13 Attributes of Mercy are listed in two places: in the Chumash, Parshas Ki Sisa, and in the Tanach, in the book of Micha.

In Parshas Ki Sisa Moshe Rabeinu needed to ask for Hashem's mercies on the Jewish people to not destroy them physically after the sin of the golden calf. Hashem's response to him was to teach him the 13 Attributes of Mercy mentioned in the parsha there (see part 1 of the translation of this maamar for a complete

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁכָּתוּב "הָרוּעָה בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים",

And this is the meaning of what is written in Shir Hashirim (6:3) regarding the month of Elul that “He nourishes me with roses”:

פִּירוּשׁ: "רוּעָה" שֶׁמִּפְרִינָס אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל לִהְיוֹת יְכוּלִים לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה – הוּא רוּעָה וּמִפְרִינָס אוֹתָם "בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים".

Meaning, that He nourishes the Jewish People with the power that they should be able to do Teshuva, He nourishes and sustains us with “roses” which have 13 petals corresponding to the 13 Attributes of Mercy that empower us to do Teshuva.

כִּי הִנֵּה בְּכָל הַשָּׁנָה אָנוּ אוֹמְרִים בְּקִרְיַת־שִׁמְעַ: "וְנָתַתִּי עֵשֶׂב בְּשָׂדֶךָ לְבִהֲמֹתֶךָ" (עֲקֹב יֵא, טו),

To understand this better: The whole year we say in Krias Shema (Devarim 11:15): “And I (Hashem) will give grass in your fields for your animals”,

פִּירוּשׁ: "בִּהֲמֹתֶךָ" הֵיינוּ נַפְשֵׁי הַבְּהֵמָה וְנַפְשֵׁי הַשְּׂכֵלִית.

The deeper meaning of “your animals” is a reference to the animal soul and the human intellect (which is invested in the animal soul).

listing of the 13 Attributes of Mercy mentioned in Ki Sisa). Those Attributes of Mercy were intended to protect the Jewish People from physical destruction, and when we mention them every day of the year it awakens Hashem’s mercy to grant us physical protection and physical life.

However the 13 Attributes of Mercy mentioned in Micha are specifically about our ability to do Teshuva, not about protection from what happens when we don’t do Teshuva, but about the very fact that we can really do Teshuva. That’s why they end off by saying “You give truth to Yaakov and kindness to Avraham, as You swore to our father from days long ago”. This means that Hashem gives us the power to do Teshuva in truth, not just Teshuva from sins but the true meaning of Teshuva, to return to our source in Hashem. This “promise to our fathers from days long ago” is that we have an essential connection to Hashem that we inherit from our forefathers, Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov, and through Teshuva we return to reveal that essential connection to the innermost Essence of Hashem.

שְׁבַכְדִּי שִׁיְהִיּוּ גַם הֵם מִסְפִּימִים שִׁיְהִיָּה
 "וְאֶהְבֶּתְ אֶת ה' כו'" (וְאֶתְחַנֵּן ו, ה), תִּקְנֻ
 לֹאמֹר תַּחֲלֶה קֹדֶם הַתַּפִּלָּה בְּרַפְת־
 יוֹצֵר, "שְׁתִּים לִפְנֵיהָ"³⁷,

"וְהָאוֹפָנִים וְחַיֹּת כו",

וּפְסוּקֵי דְזִמְרָה -

שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הָאֲרִיכוֹת בְּהִתְבּוֹנְנוֹת
 גְּדוּלַת ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ, עַד שֶׁגַם נַפְש־
 הַבְּהֵמִית וְהַשְׂכָּלִית יִסְכִּימוּ שֶׁלֹּא יֵאָתֶה
 כו'.³⁸

אֲבָל בְּשִׁבִּיל הַתְּעוֹרְרוֹת הָאֶהְבָּה בְּנַפְשׁ
 הָאֱלֹקִית עֲצָמָה, אֵין צָרִיךְ לְהִתְבּוֹנְנוֹת
 כָּל כֶּךָ, שֶׁהִרִי "נִר ה' נִשְׁמַת אָדָם" (מְשִׁלִּי
 כ, בז),

In order that they should also agree to love Hashem (as mentioned in the Shema), the Sages established to say the blessing of Yotzer Or as the first of two blessings before the Shema,

which describes how the angels, the Ofanim and Chayos, which are the spiritual source of the animal soul and the human intellect, have a great love for Hashem, and therefore the animal soul and human intellect are also able to have a great love for Hashem,

and they also established to say Pesukei Dezimra (verses of praise of Hashem that the animal soul and human intellect can relate to),

The purpose of these is that through them a person will come to a lengthy contemplation on the greatness of Hashem until even the animal soul and human intellect will agree that it is proper for all living things, including myself, to yearn only for Hashem and nothing else.

However, to awaken the G-dly soul itself to love Hashem, it isn't needed as much to have this lengthy contemplation on Hashem's greatness, since as it says in Mishlei

³⁷ (בְּרַכּוֹת יא, א).

³⁸ (עַל פִּי יִרְמְיָה י, ז: "לֹךְ יֵאָתֶה . . וּבְכָל מַלְכוּתָם מֵאֵין כְּמוֹךְ").

(20:27): “The soul of man is a flame of Hashem”,

שֶׁכֶּךָ מוֹטָבֵעַ בְּכָל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּטָבֵעַ
תּוֹלְדוֹתָם מִמְקוֹרָם, לִהְיוֹת חִפְצָם
וּתְשׁוּקָתָם לִיכָלֵל בְּאוֹר ה' וּלְדַבְּקָהּ בּוֹ.

Meaning that just like a flame is naturally drawn upwards to its source, so too it is the nature of the soul of every Jew that is derived from its source in Hashem, that its desire and yearning is to become absorbed in the Light of Hashem and to connect to Him.

Since this is the inherit nature of every Jew, therefore not as contemplation is needed to awaken the love.

וְזֶהוּ שְׂאוּמְרִים "וְנָתַתִּי עֵשֶׂב בְּשָׂדֶךָ
לְבִהֶמְתֶּךָ",

And this is the deeper meaning of what we say in the Shema: “and I (Hashem) will give grass in your fields for your animals.”

פִּירוּשׁ: "עֵשֶׂב" הֵם הַמְּלָאכִים, שְׁלוּחֵי
הַהִשְׁפָּעָה, שְׂבָהֶם וְעַל יָדָם נִמְשָׁךְ
הַהִשְׁפָּעָה מִלְמַעְלָה לִהְיוֹת לוֹ כַּח וְעוֹז
לִהְפֹּךְ נֶפֶשׁ-הַבְּהֵמָה.³⁹

Meaning: “Grass” is a reference to angels, who deliver the flow of life-force from Hashem to the lower created beings, through them Hashem’s flow of life-force is drawn down from Above to give

³⁹ [וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּזֶהָר פְּרִשֶׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית (דף יח, עמוד ב) עַל פְּסוּק (תְּהִלִּים קד, יד)
"מִצְמִיחַ חֲצִיר לְבִהֶמָּה" – אֵלֶּךָ טוֹרִין כּו', "וְעֵשֶׂב לְעִבּוֹדַת הָאָדָם" כּו']

["מִצְמִיחַ חֲצִיר לְבִהֶמָּה וגו'"] דָּא בְּהֵמָה דְּרַבִּיעָאָה עַל אֵלֶּךָ טוֹרִין וּמַגְדִּילִין לָהּ בְּכָל יוֹמָא הֵהוּא חֲצִיר.
וְ"חֲצִיר" דָּא, אֲנוּן מְלָאכִין . . וְקִיָּמִין לְמִיכְלָא דְּהָאִי בְּהֵמָה. "וְעֵשֶׂב לְעִבּוֹדַת הָאָדָם": 'עֵשֶׂב' דָּא, אֵלִין
אוֹפְנִין וְחִיּוֹת וּכְרוּבִים . . וְקִיָּמִין לְאַתְמָתָנָא בְּשַׁעְתָּא דְּבִנֵּי נָשָׁא אֲתִיָּין לְפִוּלְחָנָא דְּמֵאֲרִיָּהוֹן בְּקִרְבֵּיָהוֹן
וּבְצִלּוֹתָא, דְּדָא אִיהוּ עִבּוֹדַת הָאָדָם.

תְּרַגּוּם: "מִצְמִיחַ חֲצִיר לְבִהֶמָּה וגו'" זוֹ בְּהֵמָה שְׂרוּבָצֶת עַל אֵלֶּךָ הָרִים, וּמַגְדִּילִים לָהּ בְּכָל יוֹם אוֹתוֹ
חֲצִיר, וְ"חֲצִיר" זֶה, הֵם מְלָאכִים . . וְעוֹמְדִים לְמֵאכֹל שֶׁל הַבְּהֵמָה הַזֶּה. "וְעֵשֶׂב לְעִבּוֹדַת הָאָדָם": 'עֵשֶׂב'
זֶה, אֵלוֹ הָאוֹפְנִים וְחִיּוֹת וּכְרוּבִים . . וּמוֹכְנִים לְהִתְקֵן בְּשַׁעָה שְׂבִנֵּי אָדָם בָּאִים לְעִבּוֹדַת רַבּוֹנָם
בְּקִרְבֵּיָהֶם וּבְתַפְלָה, שְׁזוֹהִי עִבּוֹדַת הָאָדָם].

וְעֵינֵין מַה שֶּׁנִּתְבָּאָר בְּדְבוּר הַמִּתְחִיל "כִּי תֵצֵא" (לְקַמֵּן תֵּצֵא לַד, ד), מֵעֵנִין "שְׁתִּים
לִפְנֵיה" דְּקִרְיָאֵת-שְׁמַע].

power and strength to the G-dly soul to be able to transform the animal soul.

Just like grass gives physical life to physical animals, so too the angels are sent to give spiritual life to the animal soul of man, by giving the person the ability to come to an understanding about Hashem and awaken a love for Hashem in his animal soul.

This “spiritual grass” to spiritually feed our animal soul with an understanding and love for Hashem is also derived from the 13 Attributes of Mercy that we mention throughout the year (as specified in Parshas Ki Sisa).

During most of the year we see Hashem’s mercies expressed to us in two ways:

To protect us physically and give us physical life.

To enable us to refine and transform the animal soul that it should also come to love Hashem.

However, in Elul a different level of Hashem’s mercies is expressed:

וְכָל זֶה הוּא בְּכָל הַשָּׁנָה דּוֹקָא.

This level of mercies from Hashem is specifically expressed in the rest of the year.

אֲבָל בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֵלוּל כְּתִיב: "הַרוּעָה בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים", שֶׁהֵן בְּחִינַת "י"ג מְכִילִין דְּרַחֲמֵי" הַמְּאִירִים וּמְתַגַּלִּים בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֵלוּל, לְהִיּוֹת עוֹשִׂים תְּשׁוּבָה שְׂמֹולָא כָּל הַחֲסָרוֹנוֹת.

However, regarding the month of Elul it is written: “He nourishes us with roses”, which have 13 petals that correspond to the aspect of the “13 Attributes of Mercy” (as specified in Micha) that shine and are revealed in the month of Elul, which enables us to do Teshuva so that whatever revelation of Hashem that was lacking should be filled in.

[וְהַמְשָׁכָה זו, ד' שׁוֹשָׁנִים, הִיא צְרִיכָה גַם בְּשִׁבְלֵי הַנֶּפֶשׁ-הָאֱלֹקִית עֲצָמָה.

[Note of the Tzemach Tzedek: This drawing down of “roses” corresponding to Hashem’s mercies are also needed for the G-dly soul itself.

כִּי הֵגֵם שֶׁכֶּךָ מוֹטָבֵעַ בְּכָל נֶפֶשׁ כּוֹ בִּנְ"ל,

For even though it is the nature of every Jewish soul to yearn to reconnect to Hashem, so why is this extra power needed for it to do Teshuva?

אָךְ הָעִנְיָן, כִּי יֵשׁ הָעֲלָאָת מ"ן שְׁנִמְשָׁךְ מִצֶּד עֶצֶם הַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּטִבְעָהּ וּמֵאֲלֶיהָ.

The idea is that there is one level of the person's own initiative to elevate himself to Hashem that comes from his own essential nature.

אָבָל בְּדִי לָבֵא לְבַחֲיִנַת הָעֲלָאָת מ"ן דְּבַחֲיִנַת תְּשׁוּבָה, שֶׁהוּא "בְּחִילָא יִתִּיר", לְמַעְלָה מִבְּדִי שֶׁתּוֹכֵל הַנֶּפֶשׁ שָׂאת - עַל זֶה צְרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת הַמִּשְׁכָּה מְלַמֶּעֱלָה דִּיּוּקָא.⁴⁰

But in order to come to elevate himself to Hashem on a level of Teshuva with very great intensity, beyond what the soul can naturally handle, for this only when the person receives help from Above can he reach this level.

וְזֶהוּ עִנְיָן "הַשִּׁיבֵנוּ אֵלֶיךָ כו'".

This is the idea of asking Hashem "return us to You", since we need His help to reach true Teshuva beyond the natural motivation of the G-dly soul,

וְעַל הַמִּשְׁכָּה זֶה שֶׁמְלַמֶּעֱלָה נֶאֱמַר "הָרוּעָה בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים".

And regarding this type of help from Above it says that "He nourishes us with roses", feeding us His mercies and giving us power to do Teshuva. End note.]

⁴⁰ וְיֻבֵּן זֶה מִמָּה שֶׁנִּתְבָּאָר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר, עַל פְּסוּק "כָּרִיחַ שְׂדֵה אֲשֶׁר בָּרְכוּ ה'" (תוֹרָה אֹר תוֹלְדוֹת כ, ד). וְהֵינּוּ, לְהִיּוֹת "רִיחַ בּוֹגְדִיו", שֶׁהוּא בַּחֲיִנַת תְּשׁוּבָה - עַל זֶה צְרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת "אֲשֶׁר בָּרְכוּ ה'", שֶׁהוּא סִיוֵעַ מְלַמֶּעֱלָה כו'. עֵיין שָׁם.

וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ רַ"ל⁴¹: "אֵל תִּקְרֵי שׁוֹשְׁנִים
אֶלֶּא שְׁשׁוֹנִים".

Now, our Sages have said (Shabbos 30b): **“Do not only read the verse saying that ‘He nourishes us with שׁוֹשְׁנִים-roses’, but also read the verse as saying that ‘He nourishes us with שְׁשׁוֹנִים-those who study’.”**⁴²

פִּירוּשׁ: "שְׁשׁוֹנִים" הוּא בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה,
מֵעֵנֶן "קוֹרֵא וְשׁוֹנֵה כו"⁴³.

The meaning of ‘שְׁשׁוֹנִים-those who study’ is referring to Torah study, as expressed in the idea that **“whoever reads the Tanach and ‘שׁוֹנֵה-studies’ the Mishna has Hashem reading and studying with him.”** (Tanna Debei Eliyahu Rabbah 18:1)

וְהֵעֵנִן:

To explain the idea that Hashem nourishes us with ‘שׁוֹשְׁנִים-roses’ means that He nourishes us with Torah study in the month of Elul:

כִּי הַתְּשׁוּבָה צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת לְמֵלֵא כָּל
הַחֲסְרוֹנוֹת,

The idea of Teshuva is to complete whatever revelation of Hashem that is missing,

הֵן הַחֲסָרוֹן שֶׁנֶּעֱשָׂה בְּהַעֲדֵר הַמִּצְוֹת,
שֶׁמוֹנֵעַ וּמַחְסִיר גִּילּוֹי אֹרֶךְ סוֹבֵב כָּל
עֲלָמִין הַנִּמָּשֵׁךְ עַל יְדֵי הַמִּצְוֹת,

both what is missing through the lack of performing Mitzvos, which holds back and decreases the revelation of the Light of Hashem that **כָּל עֲלָמִין-encompasses all worlds** that is drawn down through the Mitzvos,

⁴¹ (שְׁבַת ל, ב. זֶה חֵלֶק ב ב, ב).

⁴² The two words שׁוֹשְׁנִים and שְׁשׁוֹנִים have the same letters, just different nekudos (vowelization). This is why we can read the verse both ways on a non-literal level of interpretation.

⁴³ (תנא דבי אליהו רבה יח, א "כָּל הַיּוֹשֵׁב וְשׁוֹנֵה, הַקְדוּשׁ בְּרוּךְ-הוּא קוֹרֵא וְשׁוֹנֵה כְּנִגְדּוֹ").

וְהֵן הַחֲסָרוֹן שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה,
שֶׁהִיא מְקוֹר בְּחִינַת 'מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין'.

and also what is missing through the lack of Torah study, which is the source of Hashem's Light that "מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין-fills all worlds".

וְזֶהוּ שְׂאוּמְרִים "וְהַחֲזִירְנוּ בְּתִשּׁוּבָה
שְׁלִימָה לְפָנֶיךָ" - שְׁלִימָה דִּיּוֹקָא כו'.

And this is the meaning of what we say in the Shemona Esrai: "and bring us back with complete Teshuva before You," meaning, specifically Teshuva that is complete in filling in all missing aspects of Hashem's revelation.

וְזֶהוּ שְׂכָתוֹב "הַרוּעָה בְּשׁוֹשָׁנִים",
שֶׁבְּכֹל זֶה יֵשׁ ב' הַמְדִּירוֹת:

And this is the meaning of the verse: "He nourishes me with 'שׁוֹשָׁנִים-roses'," in the plural form, instead of saying "with a rose", implying that there are two levels included in 'שׁוֹשָׁנִים-roses':

שׁוֹשָׁנָה כְּפִשׁוּטוֹ - הוּא הַתְּעוֹרְרוֹת "י"ג
מְכִילִין דְּרַחֲמֵי, שֶׁהֵם מְבַחֲנִית 'סוֹבֵב
כָּל עֲלָמִין';

1-An "actual rose" meaning the revelation of the 13 Attributes of Mercy corresponding to the 13 petals of the rose, which are from the level of how Hashem "סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין-encompasses all worlds", which gives us the power to do Teshuva for lack of Mitzvos,

וְ"שְׁשׁוֹנִים" - מְבַחֲנִית 'מְמַלֵּא כָּל
עֲלָמִין' כו'.

2-Those who study Torah', which has the same letters as 'שׁוֹשָׁנִים-roses', meaning that in Elul Hashem nourishes us with the power to do Teshuva for the lack of Torah study, which is the idea of how Hashem "מְמַלֵּא כָּל עֲלָמִין-fills all worlds".

After explaining that the power for Teshuva in Elul is able to fill in all the missing revelation of Hashem from the lack of Mitzvos throughout the year, the Alter Rebbe will use that concept to explain the following question:

Why is Simchas Torah, when we rejoice in the study of Torah and fulfillment of Mitzvos, celebrated after Rosh HaShana and Yom Kippur? It would seem to make more sense to celebrate the Torah at the time it was given, on Shavuot.

Rosh HaShana and Yom Kippur are about being serious in our service of Hashem and doing Teshuva for what we did improper, what does that have to do with celebrating the fact that Hashem gave us the Torah?

וְזֶהוּ עֵנִין שְׁמַחַת-תּוֹרָה שְׁאַחַר רֹאשׁ-
הַשָּׁנָה וְיוֹם-כִּפּוּר,

And this why Simchas Torah is after Rosh HaShana and Yom Kippur,

שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הַמְשָׁכָה "שְׁמַחָה שֶׁל
מִצְוָה" עַל כָּל־לֵלוֹת הַשָּׁנָה.

since it is the idea of drawing down "the joy of performing Mitzvos" for the entire year:

כִּי מֵאַחַר שֶׁבְּכָל הַשָּׁנָה עוֹשִׂים חֶסֶד
וּפָגַם בְּהֶאֱרַת 'סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין' עַל יְדֵי
שְׂאִין מְקַיְימִים הַמִּצְוֹת בְּהִלָּכָתוֹ,

Since throughout the year we create a lack in the revelation of how Hashem "סוֹבֵב כָּל עֲלָמִין" through our lack of fulfilling the Mitzvos properly,

וְכֵאֲשֶׁר נִמְשָׁךְ בְּרֹאשׁ-הַשָּׁנָה וְיוֹם-
הַכִּפּוּרִים מְלֹוי הַחֶסֶד - אֲזַי נַעֲשֶׂה
בְּחִינַת "שְׁמַחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה" כו'.⁴⁴

When that lack is filled through a new revelation of Hashem on Rosh HaShana and Yom Kippur after our Teshuva and preparation in Elul,

⁴⁴ [ועוד יובן ענין "שׁוֹשְׁנִים - שְׁשׁוֹנִים", על דרך מה שנתבאר בדבור המתחיל "ואכלת ושבעת וברכת" (לעיל עקב טו, ג), בענין הזכרת ברית ותורה בברכת הארץ, "וצריך שיקדים ברית לתורה, וזהו ניתנה בג' בריתות, וזו ניתנה ב"ג בריתות".

ומבואר שם, דענין "י"ג בריתות" הם "י"ג מדות הרחמים", והמשכתם הוא על ידי התורה כו'. וזהו שכתוב גם כן (נצבים ל, ו): "ומל' ה' אלקיך את לבבך ואת לבב זרעך", שיש בזה ראשי תיבות אלול. והיינו לבוא לבחינת פנימית-הלבב⁴⁴. והמשכה זו היא מבחינת "י"ג בריתות" שהן "י"ג מדות הרחמים". אך המשכה זו הוא על ידי התורה, וזהו ענין "שׁוֹשְׁנִים", ו"שׁוֹשְׁנִים בהלכות". וגם, כי "י"ג מדות שהתורה נדרשת בהן" הם מבחינת "י"ג מדות הרחמים". ולכן נזכר בגמרא

then we are able to truly “rejoice in the Mitzvos” since we now have the complete revelation of Hashem from all of the Mitzvos that we could have done in the past year.

The same applies to our Torah study, through our Teshuva in Elul and Rosh and Yom Kippur we able to fill in the lacking revelation of Hashem that was missing due to our lack of Torah study throughout the year.

Since we are able to accomplish the revelation of Hashem from all the Torah and Mitzvos of the past year at the time of Elul and Tishrei, we therefore celebrate that new revelation on Simchas Torah.

However, the joy of Simchas Torah is much greater than that of Shavuos, since this new revelation of Hashem from our Teshuva for all the Torah and Mitzvos of the past year is our own accomplishment. Since the purpose for which Hashem gave us the Torah is the we should reveal Hashem through our efforts in Torah, Mitzvos, and Teshuva, therefore on Simchas Torah we have the greatest celebration; we celebrate the new revelation from Hashem's Essence that was brought about through our efforts of Torah, Mitzvos, and Teshuva.

This ultimate revelation of Hashem from our own efforts comes from Hashem's power for Teshuva that He gives us in Elul.



”וְרַחֲמָנָא אָמַר“, וְהֵינּוּ, שְׂבָהֶם וְעַל יָדָם הֵמָּשְׁכָּה מִתּוֹרָה-שְׂבִכְתָּב, שֶׁהִיא חֻכְמָה-עִילָאָה – לְתוֹרָה שְׂבַע-עֲלִפָּה, שֶׁהִיא חֻכְמָה-תַּתְּאָה.

וְזֶהוּ ”וְהִדְרֵת פְּנֵי זָקֵן“ (קְדוּשִׁים יט, לב) – ”זֶה שֶׁקָּנָה חֻכְמָה“, כִּי הֵן ”י”ג תִּיקוּנֵי דִיקְנָא“.

Summary of Part 2 of the *Maamar*

Q1 What is the idea that Hashem commands us to fulfill the Mitzvos specifically “today”?

A1 “Today” means in this physical world that we are currently in. The Torah is telling us that only in the physical world do we have the power to fulfill the Mitzvos since in this world there is a revelation of Hashem’s “encompassing Light” which connects us to His Essence through the Mitzvos. For this reason, we can only do Teshuva in the physical world where the “encompassing Light” is revealed and gives us the ability to change ourselves and our actions from bad to good. Whereas in the spiritual world of Gan Eden, which is called “tomorrow” when we receive the spiritual reward for the Mitzvos, we cannot do Teshuva by ourselves, since there only Hashem’s “internalizing Light” is expressed, which does not allow for transformation.

Q2 What is the main purpose of the G-dly soul’s descent into this world?

A2 To refine and transform the human intellect, the animal soul, and the body to holiness. This is accomplished in particular through the contemplation during of Hashem’s true existence and how He creates and guides the world and ourselves, until the human intellect comes to a fiery love for Hashem and affects the animal soul and body to also love Hashem. In general, it is accomplished through studying Torah and fulfilling Mitzvos using the human intellect, animal soul and body. The amount of time allotted for the G-dly soul to stay in this world is according to how much it needs to accomplish in effecting that transformation, since every day we refine and transform one aspect of our intellectual, emotional, and physical life through our service of Hashem. Only in this physical world can such a transformation happen, due to the revelation of the “encompassing Light” of Hashem here.

Q3 What happens if we don’t accomplish that transformation of our animal soul and body to holiness because we failed to use our time properly in prayer, Torah study and Mitzva performance, is there any way to make up for it?

A3 Through Teshuva we can make up for whatever was lacking in revealing Hashem and transforming the body and animal soul. The reason that Teshuva is able to accomplish this is because it brings forth a new revelation from the Essence of Hashem which is even higher than the “encompassing Light” and “internalizing Light” that was supposed to be revealed through the Mitzvos and the Torah study.

Q4 How can we reach such a high level of revealing the Essence of Hashem through Teshuva?

A4 Through Hashem revealing the 13 Attributes of Mercy in the month of Elul He gives us the power to do Teshuva and bring about a new revelation from the Essence of Hashem.

Q5 What is the difference between the 13 Attributes of Mercy that we mention the entire year during the Tachanun prayer and the 13 Attributes of Mercy expressed specifically in Elul?

A5 The 13 Attributes of Mercy expressed year round are for Hashem to have mercy on our physical life, and to give us the power to refine the animal soul during prayer. However, the 13 Attributes of Mercy expressed in Elul are to give the G-dly soul the power to do Teshuva from the very essence of its being, beyond its normal capacity, and thereby connect to and reveal the Essence of Hashem.

Q6 Why do we celebrate Simchas Torah after Rosh Hashana and Yom Kippur, instead of on Shavuot, when the Torah was given?

A6 The greatest celebration is when we use the power given to us by Hashem to reveal Hashem through our own efforts in Torah, Mitzvos, and Teshuva. Since we accomplish the revelation of Hashem equal to that of all the Torah and Mitzvos that were lacking the entire year through our Teshuva during Elul, Rosh Hashana and Yom Kippur, therefore we celebrate that new revelation of Hashem from our own efforts after Yom Kippur, after we complete the Teshuva process.

Lessons in the Service of Hashem from Part 2 of the Maamar

- 1- In this world we can always change. No matter how much someone is “stuck” in a bad habit or destructive way of thinking or feeling, a person can always change their lifestyle and perspective from negative to positive, from unholy to holy. This is because the unlimited truth of Hashem is expressed specifically here in the physical world, and just like Hashem can do anything, he can enable us to always turn ourselves around.
- 2- We need to keep in mind that we are only here on a mission. The G-dly soul, our true essence, doesn't need any correction, it came here to accomplish something. Our main mission is to transform our human intellect, our natural emotions, and our body, to make them holy and revealing Hashem. (In addition to revealing Hashem in our animal soul and body, part of our mission is to reveal Hashem to every Jew, and by extension to everyone and everything in this world.) When we live every day that we are on a mission, and every day is vital, we will take to heart to make our time really count.
- 3- Even if we didn't use our time properly in prayer, Torah study and Mitzva performance, we have the ability to make up for it. Through Teshuva we reach a deeper level of Hashem than even that of Mitzvos, and that new revelation from Hashem compensates for everything that was lacking. But to reach the Essence of Hashem we need to reveal the essence of our G-dly soul, which takes work. The easiest time for us to reveal the essential connection we have with Hashem through our own effort is during Elul, when Hashem makes Himself available to us, giving us the power to reveal that connection.
- 4- The greatest celebration is when we work hard to accomplish something. Since Teshuva is not easy, when we actually do Teshuva, we should celebrate it much more than something that came to us as a revelation from Above.

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לע"נ

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נפטר ט"ז טבת תשכ"ד

וז' מרת **רחל** בת ר' **אברהם** ע"ה

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וז' מרת **שרה** בת ר' **יעקב** הכהן ע"ה

נפטרה י' אב תשל"ה

נדבת משפחת נאש שיחיו

לזכות יוסף יצחק בן רחל שיחי,

נולד כב תמוז תשע"ט,

שהוריו יגדלוהו לתורה ולחופה ולמעשים טובים מתוך הרחבה

משפחת ניגן

לזכות רגל הנישואין של החה"ת ר' יוסף יצחק

וב"ג הכלה המהוללה מרת אודלה

לולין

כ"ח מנחם אב, תשע"ט

שה' יברכם בבית נאמן וחסידיו וכל טוב בגו"ר